

Petrovici Ștefan

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Game Designer | AI-Powered Gameplay

I am a game designer and gameplay programmer merging seven years of technical engineering experience with a deep focus on technical narrative design and interactive storytelling. I have shipped AAA titles at Ubisoft, built advanced AI-driven game mechanics, and developed custom node-based storytelling tools for non-programmers. Whether I am prototyping new games or designing LLM-powered narrative systems, my focus is always on turning innovative concepts into seamless, engaging gameplay.

Game Design & Personal Projects

Some of the projects I work on in my spare time:

MARCH 2026

Streamer UNTIL - Narrative Designer & Tools Programmer

On a four-person game jam team, a livestream horror game where the audience is a living system that reacts to player actions. Owned the narrative system end to end: the writing, the authoring tool, and the simulation beneath it.

Designed a C# node system in Unity to simulate chat viewers and wrote 289 chat barks for different reactions.

FEBRUARY 2026 - PRESENT

ChessWorlds - Game Designer & Puzzle Designer

Created a Strategy Open-World game in Godot, established Narrative Design, created Game Design pillars and guidelines, created 28 custom puzzles, separated into 4 distinct mechanical flavors, worked on open-world level design, customized strategy gameplay feel.

2025 - PRESENT

PowerEngine & GenAI-GameEngine

I am working on a game that uses LLMs to extend gameplay features and capabilities as the game progresses, you can read more about my concepts on Substack: [PerpetualGame = game design for maximum immersiveness](#)

SEP 2024 - PRESENT

Personal Canvas: Smart Productivity and Personal Assistant app

Productivity app using AI Chats (LLMs), Agents, Modules, Google Calendar and Tasks Integration, One Drive photo importing.

- Reimagined the ChatGPT app, integrated OpenAI, Anthropic, GoogleAI models. Implemented attachments, image uploads, history, LLM functions/tools.

- Implemented Agents, using LLMs with LangChain and teaching AIs to build JavaScript apps that they could debug and see screenshots of using Puppeteer. Agents can send notifications, create files, tailor apps, keep notes, etc.
- Implemented integrations with Clerk, Google API, OneDrive, etc.
- Added diverse modules, as I found a need for them in my life, like Capital Dashboard, Daily journals, Productivity Boards, Life Areas AI advisors, etc.

PauseFramework - a framework designed to recover from run-time errors and keep the game going with the help of LLMs

2018 - 2021

6+ Video Game Projects created during college courses: Carcassonne party game, re-designed for VR, Cards Against Humanity party game, Real-world maps Bullethell Shooter, Spellgnite - a game about creating magic spells using codeblocks, joined 3+ game jams, and many other smaller game projects.

2018

The Untitled Story: the video game - Writer & Developer

Pieced together an original narrative from another artist's concept drawings (Kevin Do) and built it into a fan game on my own.

Wrote all of the dialogue and the scenes. Combined role-playing and fighting-game mechanics in RPG Maker.

Portfolio: <https://firststef.github.io/narrative-portfolio/games.html>

Professional Experience

DECEMBER 2025 - PRESENT

Ubisoft, București - AI Engineer

As an AI Engineer (R&D) in Ubisoft Online Services, turning GenAI ideas into prototypes and production systems, I:

- Turned ideas into working GenAI/LLM prototypes, MVPs, and reusable building blocks (RAG, agents, function calling, prompts, safety guardrails)
- Worked side-by-side with product/domain teams, data scientists, engineers, and cloud specialists to integrate solutions smoothly
- Sourced, cleaned, and structured datasets used for training, fine-tuning, and benchmarking
- Set up and ran automated quality checks for LLM apps (LLM-as-judge methods, scoring metrics, traces) and improved based on findings
- Reviewed results and translated them into clear recommendations and next steps for owners
- Automated workflows with CI/CD for RAG pipelines, evaluation runs, and deployments
- Wrote internal docs, playbooks, and technical guidelines to scale team knowledge

- Helped ensure new AI capabilities are used responsibly by identifying risks and proposing mitigations

OCTOBER 2023 - DECEMBER 2025 (2 years 2 months)

Ubisoft, București – *Gameplay Programmer*

- Delivered Assassin's Creed Shadows
- C++ programming and C# for build scripts or editor scripts
- Implemented gameplay features related to Character, Camera and Controls
- Added functionalities for static world assets validation
- Coordinated with an extensive team of professionals in a highly dynamic development environment

MARCH 2019 - SEPTEMBER 2023 (4 years 8 months)

Bitdefender, Iași – *Software Engineer*

- Worked on the core antivirus detection engine
- C++ programming - also used Python, JavaScript, TypeScript
- Helped build an internal library of standard functions
- Contributed to the development & design of a custom proprietary programming language
 - Created two VSCode extensions for two internal programming languages
- Developed a core engine to integrate external programming languages and transpile them to the company environment
- Constructed various web interfaces for internal projects, from static analyzers to AI train data collection for fine-tuning

Education

JUNE 2026 - AUGUST 2026

Fiction writing course – *with Marian Coman*

As a narrative designer I want to hone my skills as a writer and I enrolled to better understand fiction and the best way to write it.

MARCH 2026 - MAY 2026

Narrative Designer mentorship program – *with Ranko Trifkovic*

I really enjoy working with stories and games, and I wish to make a career out of it, so I enrolled in this program to learn about blending narrative and gameplay.

OCTOBER 2021 - JUNE 2023

Faculty Of Computer Science, Alexandru I. Cuza University, Iași – *Master Degree*

License grade: 10.0 Years mean (ECTS): 9.87

I followed my curiosity regarding the various fields of computer science, and learned many new technologies, from Blockchain technologies up to Quantum Computing and more.

OCTOBER 2021 - PRESENT

Faculty Of Psychology and Education Sciences, Alexandru I. Cuza University, Iași

- Bachelor Degree

License grade: 9.25 Years mean (ECTS): 8.99

I learned many interesting aspects of the human mind and how we can understand ourselves and each other better.

OCTOBER 2018 - JULY 2021

Faculty Of Computer Science, Alexandru I. Cuza University, Iași - Bachelor Degree

License grade: 10.0 Years mean (ECTS): 9.02

Game Design course: graded 10 in the final exam

The 3 year period of pursuing my Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science has been rewarding but demanding, focusing on learning each major thoroughly, whilst also working as a full-time Software Engineer.

Languages

Romanian - native language

English - C1 (professional working proficiency)

Links

Github: <https://github.com/firststef>

Itch: <https://firststef.itch.io/>

Linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/stefan-petrovici-8137ab211/>